JEREMY TOPAKA

Software Engineer | React Native · Node.js · Firebase

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SUMMARY

Software engineer and AI-native builder. I use AI assistants (Claude) throughout development, for prototyping, code and debugging, while I own the architecture, code review, security and testing. With this workflow I have shipped three full-stack apps solo with React Native/Expo: an end-to-end encrypted messenger on a custom Node.js/WebSocket backend, a B2B fleet dispatch tool and a B2C marketplace on Firebase. Four years of IT support and 16+ years in visual art bring strong troubleshooting skills and a designer's eye.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages & Front-End: JavaScript (ES6+), React Native, React, Expo (EAS, OTA updates), HTML, CSS, PWA / Service Workers
Back-End & Data: Node.js, REST APIs, WebSockets, Firebase (Auth, Firestore, Storage, Cloud Functions), data modeling
Real-Time & Security: WebRTC, WebCrypto (ECDH, AES-GCM), end-to-end encryption, password hashing (scrypt), rate limiting
Cloud & DevOps: Google Cloud, Docker, Caddy, Netlify, DNS & domains, Git/GitHub, App Store & Google Play releases, push (FCM, APNs)
AI & Design: Claude API, AI-assisted development, UI/UX design, Figma prototyping

PROJECTS

LitChat — Encrypted messaging app for low-data markets (litchat.space) **Web · iOS · Android**

Founder & Full-Stack Engineer | Beta on iOS TestFlight and Google Play testing

- Built a bilingual (English/French) end-to-end encrypted messenger for prepaid-data users: about 0.33 KB per message and a 34 KB first load, written in framework-free JavaScript.
- Designed a Node.js real-time backend with 108 REST routes and a compact WebSocket protocol: offline queuing, delivery receipts, presence, typing and group messaging.
- Implemented end-to-end encryption with WebCrypto (ECDH P-256 + AES-GCM) for messages, photos, voice notes, statuses and backups; PINs hashed with scrypt and rate-limited.
- Built low-bandwidth WebRTC voice calls (Opus at 10 kbps, about 0.1–0.2 MB a minute) with native CallKit on iPhone.
- Shipped React Native/Expo apps with OTA updates and push; runs on Google Cloud with Docker and Caddy, plus an admin dashboard using the Claude API.
- Built with an AI-assisted workflow: AI drafts code and docs; I design the system, review every change and gate deploys behind 55 end-to-end tests.

DriverRoom — Gate code & dispatch app for delivery fleets (driverroom.dev — notice: new website in progress) **iOS · Android · Web**

Founder, Developer & UI/UX Designer

- Built a React Native/Expo app that gives delivery drivers a shared, encrypted gate code database, unlocked only on duty.
- Modeled 15 Firestore collections with four roles (driver, trainer, company, admin), account approval and live listeners for the duty roster, chat and notices.
- Built dispatch tools: on-duty roster, check-in, rescues, returns, return-to-station and 9-hour auto off-duty.
- Added team chat, notices and three plan tiers; shipped iOS, Android and web builds with EAS and Netlify, plus an admin dashboard.

EliteReply — Global e-commerce & booking marketplace (elitereply.info) **iOS · Android**

Founder, Developer & UI/UX Designer

- Built a React Native/Expo + Firebase marketplace where African businesses sell and take bookings from the diaspora.
- Integrated payment gateway options into checkout and designed the shopping and booking flows end to end.
- Deployed with EAS and set up DNS and domain management for the live site.

EXPERIENCE

IT Support Technician — QKCHIC, Alpharetta, GA **2021 – 2023**

- Diagnosed, repaired and upgraded Windows and Mac computers, printers and peripherals; installed and configured Windows.
- Branded new HP motherboards with HP proprietary software; set up HubSpot CRM automation for sequences and workflows.

IT Support Technician — ThredUp, Suwanee, GA **2019 – 2021**

- Supported about 2,700 users by phone and remote access, resolving software, hardware and network issues.
- Rolled out software updates four times a year, backed up user data and proposed system improvements.

Line Leader — ZF North America, Flowery Branch, GA **2016 – 2019**

EDUCATION

Flatiron School — Software Engineering **2022**

ISIPA, DR Congo — Bachelor's Degree, System Administration **2014**

Languages: English (professional), French (fluent), Lingala (fluent)